

BSSS-183
LIFE SKILLS
TUTOR MARKED ASSIGNMENTS

Course code: BSSS-183

Assignment Code: BSSS-183/AST/TMA

July 2025 – January 2026

Marks: 100

Note: Attempt any five questions. The assignment is divided into two Sections 'A' and 'B'. You have to attempt at least two questions from each section in about 500 words each. All questions carry equal marks.

SECTION-A

1. What do you understand by verification and attestation of an affidavit? Explain.

Answer: Verification and attestation are important parts of an affidavit because they establish the authenticity of the statements made by the person who signs it. An affidavit is a written statement of facts made voluntarily and sworn or affirmed before a person legally authorised to administer an oath or affirmation.

Verification means that the person making the affidavit confirms that the statements contained in it are true to the best of their knowledge and belief. A proper verification normally distinguishes between facts personally known to the deponent and facts based on information received from other sources. The deponent should clearly indicate which statements are based on personal knowledge and which are based on information believed to be true. This helps the court or authority understand the basis of each statement.

Attestation refers to the formal certification that the affidavit was signed or sworn before an authorised person. Depending on the applicable law and procedure, this may be done by a notary public, oath commissioner, magistrate or another authorised officer. The authorised person checks the identity of the deponent and witnesses the signing or administration of the oath or affirmation. The attesting officer then places a signature, seal or other prescribed authentication on the document.

The distinction is therefore important: verification concerns the truth and source of the statements made by the deponent, while attestation concerns the formal witnessing and authentication of the execution of the affidavit. Both processes increase the reliability of the document.

A false statement in an affidavit can have serious legal consequences, particularly when it is knowingly or deliberately made. For this reason, a deponent should read the entire affidavit carefully, ensure that the facts are accurate, and sign only after understanding its contents. Thus, verification and attestation together provide procedural safeguards and help courts and public authorities rely on affidavits as formal evidence.

2. Good public health begins with maintaining personal hygiene. Comment.

Answer: Personal hygiene refers to the everyday practices through which a person keeps the body clean and reduces the risk of infection. It is closely connected with public health because many communicable diseases can spread through contaminated hands, food, water, respiratory droplets and unclean surroundings. Good personal hygiene therefore protects not only the individual but also family members, classmates, colleagues and the wider community.

Handwashing is one of the simplest and most effective hygiene practices. Hands should be washed with soap and clean water, particularly before eating or preparing food and after using the toilet. Regular bathing, oral care, clean clothes and proper care of hair and nails also help reduce the accumulation and transmission of microorganisms.

Food hygiene is equally important. Food should be prepared with clean hands and utensils, stored safely and protected from contamination. Drinking water should come from a safe source. Raw and cooked foods should be handled separately where appropriate, and perishable foods should be stored under suitable conditions.

Respiratory hygiene also contributes to public health. Covering the mouth and nose while coughing or sneezing, disposing of tissues properly and staying home when seriously unwell can reduce the spread of respiratory infections. Keeping homes, classrooms, workplaces and public spaces clean further supports healthy living.

Personal hygiene alone cannot eliminate all public-health problems. Safe drinking water, sanitation, waste management, vaccination, health education and accessible medical services are also essential. Nevertheless, personal hygiene forms an important first line of defence. When healthy habits are followed by large numbers of people, the collective benefit can be significant.

Thus, the statement that good public health begins with personal hygiene highlights the relationship between individual behaviour and community well-being. Hygiene practices are simple, relatively inexpensive and can become effective when they are performed consistently and supported by appropriate public-health infrastructure.

3. Discuss various approaches to understand disability.

Answer: Disability can be understood through several approaches, and each approach highlights a different aspect of the relationship between impairment, the individual and society. Understanding these approaches is important because the way disability is defined influences education, employment, accessibility and social policy.

The medical model views disability mainly in terms of an individual's physical, sensory, intellectual or mental impairment. Under this approach, medical diagnosis, treatment, rehabilitation and prevention receive considerable attention. It can be useful for identifying health needs and providing clinical or rehabilitative support. However, by focusing mainly on the individual, it may not fully explain the barriers created by society.

The social model shifts attention from the impairment itself to environmental and social barriers. A person may have an impairment, but disability can become more severe when buildings are inaccessible, information is unavailable in suitable formats, transport is difficult to use or discriminatory attitudes restrict participation. The social model therefore emphasises removal of barriers and equal participation.

The rights-based approach understands persons with disabilities as holders of equal rights rather than merely recipients of care. It focuses on dignity, non-discrimination, accessibility, participation, education, employment and equal opportunity. This approach is closely associated with modern disability policy and international human-rights principles.

The biopsychosocial approach combines biological, psychological and social factors. It recognises that health conditions and impairments matter, but also considers personal circumstances, behaviour, social relationships and the environment. This provides a broader understanding of functioning and participation.

The charity or welfare approach historically treated persons with disabilities primarily as people requiring sympathy, care or assistance. While support services are necessary, a purely charitable approach can unintentionally reinforce dependence or the idea that disabled persons are passive recipients.

A contemporary understanding therefore benefits from combining appropriate medical support with accessibility, social inclusion and rights. Disability is not only a question of an individual's condition; it is also shaped by the interaction between the person and the environment. An inclusive society seeks both appropriate support and removal of unnecessary barriers.

4. Write a note on the importance of gender sensitization.

Answer: Gender sensitization means developing awareness and understanding about gender roles, stereotypes, discrimination and unequal treatment, and encouraging respectful and equitable behaviour. It is important because many social expectations about what women, men and people of different gender identities should do are learned through family, education, media and institutions.

Gender stereotypes can influence educational choices, employment opportunities, household responsibilities and participation in public life. For example, assumptions that certain subjects or occupations are suitable only for one gender can restrict individual choices. Similarly, unequal expectations about domestic work can create an unfair distribution of responsibilities.

Gender sensitization helps people identify such assumptions and understand the importance of dignity, consent, equality and mutual respect. In schools and colleges, it can encourage students to participate equally, challenge discriminatory language and recognise inappropriate behaviour. In workplaces, it can support fair recruitment, professional conduct and a safer environment.

Another important aspect is awareness of gender-based violence and harassment. Sensitization programmes can explain boundaries, consent, respectful communication and available reporting mechanisms. They can also help bystanders understand how to respond appropriately when they observe discriminatory or abusive behaviour.

Gender sensitization should not mean treating everyone as identical. Rather, it involves recognising differences without turning those differences into a basis for unequal rights or opportunities. It encourages people to examine how social norms affect different groups and to create environments in which individuals can develop their abilities freely.

Effective sensitization is not achieved through a single lecture. It requires continuous education, inclusive institutional policies, responsible media representation and opportunities for discussion. Teachers, parents, employers, community leaders and public institutions all have a role.

Thus, gender sensitization contributes to equality and respectful social relationships. It can reduce prejudice, improve awareness of rights and responsibilities, and help create educational, professional and public environments in which people are treated with dignity.

5. Explain the importance of Data Management.

Answer: Data management is the organised process of collecting, storing, processing, protecting, maintaining and using data so that it remains accurate, accessible and useful. In modern life, organisations and individuals generate large quantities of digital information. Effective data management is therefore essential for sound decision-making and efficient operations.

One major benefit is accuracy. Poorly maintained data can contain duplicate, outdated or inconsistent information. Data management practices such as validation, standardisation and regular updating help improve quality. Accurate data allows organisations to make decisions based on reliable information rather than assumptions.

Data management also improves accessibility. Well-organised files, databases and information systems make it easier for authorised users to find the information they need. Clear naming conventions, indexing, metadata and structured storage reduce the time spent searching for records.

Security and privacy are equally important. Personal, financial, academic and organisational information may be sensitive. Access controls, authentication, encryption, backups and appropriate retention policies can reduce the risk of unauthorised access or data loss. Data should be accessed only by people who have a legitimate need and appropriate permission.

Good data management also supports analysis and planning. Organisations can use reliable data to identify patterns, evaluate performance, forecast needs and improve services. In education, for example, student records can help institutions monitor attendance and academic progress. In business, sales and customer data can support planning and inventory management.

Backup and recovery are essential components because hardware failure, accidental deletion, cyber incidents or natural disasters can cause data loss. Maintaining secure backups and testing recovery procedures increases resilience.

Data management also involves ethical and legal responsibilities. Organisations should collect information for legitimate purposes, avoid unnecessary collection, protect confidential information and follow applicable data-protection requirements.

In conclusion, data management turns raw information into a dependable organisational resource. It supports accuracy, accessibility, security, continuity and informed decision-making. As the amount of digital information continues to grow, responsible data management becomes increasingly important for individuals, institutions and society.

SECTION-B

6. Explain the significance of search engines in facilitating web-browsing.

Answer: Search engines are tools that help users locate information available on the World Wide Web. Instead of knowing the exact address of every website, a user can enter keywords or a question and receive a list of relevant results. Search engines therefore make web-browsing faster and more practical.

A search engine generally uses automated programmes to discover and index web pages. When a user submits a query, the system searches its index and presents results according to algorithms designed to estimate relevance. Modern search engines can handle text, images, videos, maps, news and other forms of information.

Search engines are important for education and research. Students can locate academic resources, government information, tutorials, reference materials and current information. They also help users compare information from multiple sources. Effective searching requires suitable keywords, quotation marks for exact phrases and, when available, filters for date, language or source type.

Search engines also help users discover services and practical information such as public websites, transport information, product documentation and contact details. For businesses and organisations, visibility in search results can help people discover their services and information.

However, search engines do not guarantee that every result is accurate or unbiased. Results may include advertisements, low-quality pages, outdated information or misleading content. Users should therefore evaluate the source, author, date and supporting evidence before relying on important information.

Privacy is another consideration. Search activity can reveal interests and behaviour, and different search services have different privacy practices. Users should understand the privacy settings and policies of the services they use.

Overall, search engines are a central gateway to the web. They reduce the difficulty of finding information, support learning and communication, and help users navigate the enormous volume of online content. Their usefulness is greatest when users combine effective search techniques with careful evaluation of the information they find.

7. Discuss some of the best practices for protecting personal information online.

Answer: Protecting personal information online requires a combination of good habits, secure technology and awareness of common threats. Personal information may include passwords, financial details, identification numbers, contact information, photographs, location data and private communications.

Strong and unique passwords are an important first step. A separate password should ideally be used for each important account so that a breach of one service does not automatically expose other accounts. Password managers can help users create and store strong passwords securely. Multi-factor authentication provides an additional layer of protection because a password alone is not sufficient for access.

Users should also be cautious about phishing. Fraudulent emails, messages and websites may imitate banks, government services, employers or familiar companies in order to obtain passwords or financial information. Before clicking a link or sharing information, users should verify the sender and website address through a trusted route.

Privacy settings should be reviewed regularly on social-media and other online services. Users should avoid publicly sharing information that could be misused, such as passwords, financial details, identity documents or unnecessary personal location information.

Devices and software should be kept updated because security updates often address known vulnerabilities. Antivirus and security features should be enabled where appropriate. Important data should be backed up so that accidental deletion or ransomware does not result in permanent loss.

Public Wi-Fi should be used carefully, particularly for sensitive transactions. Users should also lock their phones and computers with a secure authentication method and avoid installing software from untrusted sources.

When shopping or making payments online, users should check that they are using the intended website and a secure connection, and should monitor bank and account activity for unusual transactions.

Protecting personal information is therefore an ongoing process. Good digital habits, strong authentication, cautious sharing, software updates and awareness of scams together reduce privacy and security risks.

8. Is there a difference between saving and investment? Explain with examples.

Answer: Saving and investment are related but different financial activities. Saving generally means setting aside money for future use, usually in relatively safe and accessible forms. Investment means putting money into assets or financial instruments with the expectation of earning a return over time, while accepting some degree of risk.

Savings are commonly used for short-term or emergency needs. Examples include keeping money in a savings bank account or a suitable deposit account. The main priorities are safety, liquidity and easy access. A person may save for an upcoming fee, household expense or emergency fund.

Investment generally has a longer-term objective. Examples can include shares, bonds, mutual funds or other permitted investment products. The value of investments can rise or fall, and returns are not always guaranteed. The level of risk depends on the particular investment.

For example, suppose a student sets aside ₹20,000 in a bank savings account to meet an expected educational expense within a few months. This is saving because the primary objective is to preserve the money and keep it accessible. If another ₹20,000 is placed into a diversified long-term investment with the objective of growth over several years, it is an investment, subject to the risks of that product.

Savings and investments also differ in their relationship with inflation. Money kept in very low-risk forms may lose purchasing power over long periods if its return is lower than inflation. Investments may provide higher potential returns, but they also carry greater uncertainty and can result in losses.

A sensible financial plan often uses both. An emergency reserve can provide liquidity, while long-term investments can be used for goals that are many years away. The appropriate balance depends on income, expenses, time horizon, risk tolerance and financial objectives.

Thus, saving primarily focuses on safety and accessibility, whereas investment focuses on growth or income over time and involves greater risk. They should not be treated as identical, even though both involve setting money aside for future needs.

9. Do you agree that digitalisation has created new avenues of employment? Justify.

Answer: Digitalisation has created new forms of work and has also changed the way many traditional occupations are performed. The expansion of internet access, smartphones, cloud services, digital payments, e-commerce and software platforms has created employment opportunities in both technology-related and non-technology sectors.

Direct technology employment includes roles such as software development, web design, cybersecurity, data analysis, cloud administration and technical support. Digitalisation has also created work in content creation, digital marketing, online education and platform-based services.

Traditional sectors have also changed. Banks use digital systems, retailers use online platforms, hospitals maintain electronic records and educational institutions increasingly use digital learning tools. These changes create demand for people who can operate, manage and support digital systems.

Digital platforms have also enabled remote and freelance work. A person with suitable skills may provide services to clients outside their local area through online platforms. Small businesses can reach customers through websites, social media and digital marketplaces, creating new commercial opportunities.

However, digitalisation can also change or reduce demand for some tasks, particularly repetitive activities that can be automated. Workers may therefore need to acquire new skills. Digital literacy, communication, problem-solving and specialised technical skills can improve a person's ability to adapt to changing employment requirements.

Digital employment also presents challenges. Gig and platform work may involve irregular income, limited employment benefits or uncertain working conditions depending on the arrangement. Access to reliable internet and digital devices is

another factor, so the benefits of digitalisation are not distributed equally.

Overall, digitalisation has clearly expanded the range of employment activities available in many sectors, while simultaneously transforming existing jobs. The long-term benefit depends partly on education, skill development, digital infrastructure and appropriate labour protections. Therefore, the growth of digital work should be understood as both an opportunity for new employment and a process that requires workers and institutions to adapt.

10. Is it true that a good CV always helps in search of a job? Comment.

Answer: A well-prepared CV can be an important tool in a job search because it presents a candidate's education, skills, experience and achievements in a concise form. However, a good CV does not by itself guarantee employment. Its usefulness depends on the job, the employer, the applicant's qualifications and the overall recruitment process.

A good CV should be accurate, clear and relevant to the position. It should highlight qualifications and experience that match the job requirements rather than containing unnecessary information. A simple structure, consistent formatting and correct contact details make it easier for recruiters to review.

A CV can also help an applicant pass an initial screening stage. Many organisations use applicant-tracking systems or other screening processes, so using relevant job-related terms and presenting information clearly may help the application be understood correctly. The candidate should never include false qualifications or experience.

Nevertheless, recruitment usually involves more than a CV. Depending on the position, an employer may consider application forms, tests, interviews, references, portfolios, practical demonstrations and background verification. A strong CV may secure an interview, but performance in later stages remains important.

The effectiveness of a CV also depends on the quality of the job search itself. Applying only to suitable vacancies, following instructions carefully and preparing for interviews can matter as much as the document. Networking, internships, professional profiles and demonstrated skills may also contribute to employment opportunities.

A CV should therefore be viewed as one part of a broader job-search strategy. It provides an opportunity to communicate a candidate's suitability and obtain consideration, but it cannot remove competition or guarantee selection. The most useful approach is to maintain an honest, updated and job-specific CV and combine it with appropriate skills, preparation and professional conduct.

Prepared as a study-oriented solved answer set. Students should follow the original assignment instructions and select the required questions for submission.